

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
♥ J 10 8 6
♦ Q 9 7 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A 6
♥ 9 7 2
♦ K 10 8 3
♣ A K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 8
♥ K Q
♦ A 6 5
♣ J 7 6 3

♠ 10 7 4 2
♥ A 5 4 3
♦ J 4
♣ 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass			6NT

6NT by South
fall doubleton.

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 15 points you are supposed to pass. With 17 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. Wouldn't you know it, 16 points. Today you feel bold, so you say 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♥ J.

East plays the ♥ A and returns the ♥ 3.

Winner List: ♠ = 4 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

One trick is already lost and at first glance it looks like your only slim chance will be for the ♦ Q J to

But a dummy has a very important card, the ♥ 9. You know from the opening lead that West holds the ♥ 10, so if he happens to hold the only guard in ♦ s you will be able to squeeze him in the red suits.

You don't even have to do anything special. Play your 4 ♣ winners, then 3 ♠ winners.

Now play the ♠ J and watch West's discard. If he throws the ♥ 10 dummy's ♥ 9 will become a winner. If he doesn't throw the ♥ 10 then you know dummy's ♥ 9 is worthless so discard it and hope the ♦ s are good.

Squeeze plays can be complex to figure out and difficult to execute.

But not always. Sometimes they just happen, like this one. You were really hoping for the ♦ Q and ♦ J to fall and you fell into the squeeze instead.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ K 7 4
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ 10 6 5 3 2

♠ Q 7 3
 ♥ A 10 5 3
 ♦ A J 7
 ♣ K Q 9



♠ A K J 9 6 4
 ♥ J
 ♦ 10 5 3
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ Q 9 8 6 2
 ♦ K Q 6
 ♣ A 8

West	North	East	South
	1NT	2♠	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

When partner opens 1NT, interference can easily gum up your smooth bidding sequences. Playing the lebensohl convention, your 3♥ bid shows a 5-card suit and is forcing to game.

It doesn't always work out so well, but here partner had an easy 4♥ bid.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠10.

Whatever you play, East takes the ♠ A K J and then plays a small ♣. West started with just one ♠.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = ? : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = ?

Don't let that Question Mark by the ♥ losers mislead you - if you are going to make this contract you cannot lose a ♥ trick at all! Is there any hope?

The odds aren't good, but you actually have **TWO** possibilities for success. If West holds the singleton ♥K, you can play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥A, dropping the ♥K, then finesse East out of his ♥J. Or, if East holds the singleton ♥J you can play your ♥Q, finessing West for the ♥K and at the same time smothering East's ♥J.

Which basket will you put your eggs into?

The answer is simple Bridge math! East started with 6 ♠s leaving him 7 cards outside the ♠ suit. West started with just 1 ♠, leaving him with 12 cards outside the ♠ suit. Obviously East is much more likely to have a singleton ♥ than West.

So you win the ♣A in your hand, play the ♥Q and let it ride if West does not cover.

Then you

Ahh, success.

But to tell the truth, the Bridge math wasn't really complete. Distribution-wise it was just fine, but there is also the question of strength.

The fact that East overcalled makes it more likely that he holds more high cards than West, and this skews the odds toward East holding the ♥K.

But think about it. If East does in fact hold the singleton ♥K, and if you cleverly drop it by playing dummy's ♥A it won't help you. You will then have to lose a trick to West's ♥J.